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Precarious jobs, parental divorces and an entrepreneurial mindset: for Gen Z and Millennials, the prenuptial agreement is a sentimental business plan. Couples are discovering that talking about money can be more intimate than the words "forever".

Text by ENRICA BROCARDO

Love is NOT infinite and prenups explain it well

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During our Zoom conversation, Julia Rodgers uses the word "romantic" several times. Yet she isn't talking about a particularly imaginative marriage proposal or a wedding ceremony on a beach in Mauritius, but about a *prenup*, the short version of *prenuptial agreement*. In other words, those premarital agreements that we learned about through the "bloodiest" celebrity divorces in Hollywood but which, for some years now, have become common practice in the United States, to the point that some even organize a "prenup party" with friends upon signing.

According to a recent survey by market research firm Harris Poll, 41% of Gen Z respondents in America have signed one of these agreements, a figure that rises to 47% among Millennials. And according to another YouGov survey, this time conducted in Great Britain, over 50% of those under 45 expressed a willingness to sign one.

Rodgers is the founder and CEO of HelloPrenup, one of the most well-known platforms specializing in DIY contracts for future spouses. "As a family law attorney, I also handled prenuptial agreements," she says. "And often my clients would ask me: 'But why do I have to hire a lawyer and spend a bunch of money? Can't we just agree between ourselves?'. It's not so much about talking about divorce, but about how you want to live together. If we have children, will we both continue to work? How much savings do we want to set aside? Is it okay if the in-laws come to live with us too?".

The reasons why young people are considering signing a contract before the wedding are diverse. One is that self-employment has almost become the norm for Gen Z, accustomed to approaching their careers and life with an entrepreneurial mindset: for those under 30, even the couple is a start-up, and everyone knows every start-up requires a business plan. Furthermore, many of them have separated or divorced

parents; in short, they know that "forever" is a relative concept. But the media has also played a role, normalizing the idea of prenups in series like *All's Fair* and even more so on Instagram and TikTok where the topic is shared and explained by various successful influencers.

According to Rodgers, these contracts have two purposes. "On one hand, there are agreements that also have legal value; on the other, it's about sitting down and understanding if you truly want the same things and if there are deal-breakers that for one of the two would mean the end of the relationship." An example? Infidelity. "Since the video of that secret proposal at the Coldplay concert went viral, requests to include an infidelity clause have increased by 3%," she explains. "Which doesn't mean a judge would necessarily give the green light to a financial penalty against the cheater. However, discussing it beforehand is still important." And she adds that, especially since younger generations consider open relationships normal, as the perception of what is permissible is very subjective, some prefer to go into detail. "I've had couples who wrote that sex with third parties was only allowed provided the other spouse was present in the room."

What were once considered celebrity quirks—like the clause establishing a certain number of sexual encounters per month or the one for which Nicole Kidman's husband, Keith Urban, wouldn't get a cent if he started using drugs or alcohol again—can end up in anyone's files. There are women who commit to paying a certain sum for every kilo gained in pregnancy that isn't lost within six months of birth, or husbands who sign for a monthly "allowance" for the wife's shopping. But at the moment of separation, in many cases, these are just scraps of paper: no divorce lawyer would advise their clients to go to court to claim the validity of such agreements.

On the other hand, there are several non-economic issues that do have legal value. This is the case with clauses on frozen embryos: who pays the storage costs? Who owns them? The same applies to the "social image" clause, which essentially provides that, in the event of divorce or separation, nothing potentially defamatory about the other person can be published online, under penalty. Just as the so-called *Sunset clause* is valid, which establishes in advance the maximum duration of the signed prenuptial agreement.

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On prenup coach websites and other platforms like First or Neptune—which, incidentally, are almost always launched by women—the focus is often on the "educational" value. After all, to get a driver's license you have to pass an exam and a

driving test; it makes sense that to get married it's enough to sign some papers, get in a line, and say yes to a few questions without having studied? Especially in America where economic divorce conditions change from state to state and where there are even some states, like Texas and New Hampshire, in which by law a long cohabitation is equated to marriage: you thought it was enough to say goodbye and instead you find yourself having to pay alimony to your ex-partner.

But let's come to Italy where premarital agreements have only recently been discussed. Lawyer Maria Grazia Di Nella, specialized in Family Law, explains: "In July last year, a ruling by the Supreme Court set some fixed points regarding the validity of premarital agreements. Although many called it revolutionary, in reality, once again, it established that only property aspects can be regulated, within very specific limits and always to protect the weaker party."

Let's look at a couple of examples: you cannot establish that in the event of the birth of children, their maintenance will be the sole responsibility of one of the two, while it is permissible to agree, in case of separation, on the restitution of the sum invested in the purchase of a house that, perhaps for tax reasons, was registered to only one of the spouses. "Italian jurisprudence evaluates agreements on the regulation of a future separation stipulated before the marriage with great severity. Normally they are considered unlawful and therefore inapplicable. In our culture, marriage is considered a sacrament rather than a contract. For this reason, although it may seem paradoxical, unmarried couples can freely define every aspect of cohabitation including the consequences of the end of the relationship." The "cohabitation contract" made with a private writing authenticated by a notary can regulate the management of household expenses, those related to pets, who gets the furniture, the car, in case of a breakup. Even providing for a penalty in case of betrayal.

Ginevra Zucconi Galli Fonseca, financial consultant, known on Instagram with the account *Lafinanzadonna*, maintains that, laws aside, the most important thing is to be pragmatic. "Unfortunately in Italy even today talking about money is not romantic. And instead, in relationships, transparency about salaries, eventual investments and debts is fundamental. Trust is fine, but only up to a certain point." The new generations, fortunately, are generally more attentive and aware and the idea that dealing with economic and financial management is a male prerogative belongs mostly to the past. "Because girls are more emancipated, but also because they live in a precarious job market and know they cannot count on a future pension, which will be much lower than the income perceived during their working years." Her advice: "Create a real common financial project, map current accounts, investments, insurance and so on, discussing the couple's expense management in advance. There is no right or wrong method, the important thing is to have one and talk about it openly. Another recommendation, whether you are married or not, is to always keep a personal current account in addition to the common one. The same for investments. And never delegate: decisions, all of them, must be made together."

"Unfortunately in Italy even today talking about money is not romantic. And instead, in relationships, transparency about salaries, eventual investments and debts is fundamental. Trust is fine, but only up to a certain point"

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BUZZ

Golden Rule

Milanese design as an *inspiring muse* and the garment understood as a home in which to inhabit the body. These are the aesthetic pillars of the brand **Sasuphi** which, with its *architecture of femininity* and *polite Milanese elegance*, has even conquered the cinema and the "devil" herself, Miranda Priestly...

Text by MARTA SALADINO

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Milan is a fragile balance between beauty and utility, where "architecture is a crystal," to quote Gio Ponti; and, as Piero Portaluppi—another enlightened proponent of Milanese design—maintained, "blending is far from disorder," but follows a golden rule that wisely combines severe industrial rationalism and measured, bourgeois, calm classicism. The constant search for a golden ratio is the same one on which two friends, **Sara Ferrero** and **Susanna Cucco**, built the foundations of their brand Sasuphi in 2021. The name plays with their initials joined with the Greek letter *phi*—referring to the Fibonacci sequence—while also creating a resonance with the French *ça suffit* (that’s enough), cementing an elegance that is polite, chic enough, yet rock-solid in its Milanese DNA.

The clothes are private dwellings to live in, an "architecture of femininity"—as they like to define it—which has just debuted at the Fondazione Giangiacomo Feltrinelli, designed by Herzog & de Meuron, with a manifesto of rigor, delicacy, and free discipline. It features sculpted knitwear, fluid tailoring, English rib patterns, necklace-collars, and the debut of the *Phi* shoe, created with Diego Dolcini, featuring a medium heel and a graphic cashmere gaiter that transforms it into a boot. A cultured, non-screaming grammar that knows how to make itself heard and, above all, noticed by Jack Poser, the costume designer for the highly anticipated sequel to *The*

Devil Wears Prada. He immediately set his sights on their *Lauren* coat (named in honor of Lauren Hutton), as the two creatives recount in unison.

Expected success or unexpected? "So unexpected that it was almost a miracle we even replied to the email. It came from a generic sender we didn't know, with a vague request for clothes regarding the scheduling of a top-secret film. It was unusual. We were cautious but sent the pieces anyway to let the actress choose. After trying on a bunch, she put on our *Lauren* overcoat, rolling up the sleeves and exclaiming: 'I got her'. Not just anyone, but Meryl Streep, aka Miranda Priestly. We couldn't believe it. The devil wears Sasuphi..."

Your garments embody the "power dressing" of the character... "Our jacket has a recognizable cut in its calibrated rigor: the turned-back cuff with the signature triangle that allows the shirt or perhaps a piece of jewelry to stand out, the side slits and, precisely, the strategic elastic for the sleeves."

What are your aesthetic pillars? "We think of the woman, not the fashion, starting from a pragmatic concept: our DNA originates from purpose, from wearable architecture. And knitwear, between cashmere and silk, is the backbone of a reasoned femininity."

"We think of the woman, not the fashion, starting from a pragmatic concept; our DNA originates from purpose, from wearable architecture. And knitwear, between cashmere and silk, is the backbone of a reasoned femininity" — SARA FERRERO AND SUSANNA CUCCO

Themes for S/S 2026? "The concept of separates, which we often draw from the male wardrobe, as in the case of a very formal pair of trousers balanced by an ironic yellow sweater. Or a shirt over a long skirt with exaggerated proportions through overlaps of weight, luminosity, and material layering. Women need contrasts in perfect balance."

What is the difference for you between the American and Italian client? "Compared to the Milanese client—or rather, the Italian one—who already has a defined taste and buys a specific piece to mix and reuse in her wardrobe, the American client tends to buy the complete look, the total solution. These are two different approaches. Our brand shouldn't be explained; you just have to 'Sasuphize' yourself a bit."

Is the way we shop changing? "The department store crisis—the self-service effect—has highlighted the fact that people need human contact, a relationship, an experience that makes them feel special, even just for advice or a chat. In fact, in America, the personal stylist is returning; there are closets that are too full and too much loneliness."

Is clothing a business card? "Dressing is an important element for defining who you want to be, who you are, and also how you want to appear. It is the house of the body. Not for nothing, we shot the images of the collection with normal Sasuphi women in their own homes. Our clothes worn in an intimate, private, personal place."

There is a constant parallelism between design and tactile form, architecture and tailoring. And always Milan as a muse and spectator... "Milanese architecture is a reflection of our codes: masculine and feminine, classics as much as hyper-modern, conceptual yet organic—'tender radical,' in short. Our stylistic reference points are Piero Portaluppi, Gio Ponti, Gae Aulenti, but also the lamps of Michael Anastassiades or the light studies of Niko Koronis. Enlightened design meets industrial craftsmanship and creative flair, uniting for a functional aesthetic. *Ça suffit*..."

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CONFIDENTIAL

The siren's song

In Sirivannavari's design there is the magic of the abyss and an affirmation of identity

Text by MARTA MARIANI

Fashion as a guardian and interpreter of a cultural identity and the roots of a people, the Thai people. «Everything starts from a love for diving, a passion for marine life, and from a deep commitment to safeguarding the environment». The words of Her Royal Highness Princess Sirivannavari Nariratana Rajakanya, creative director of Sirivannavari, accompany us into an evocative and fascinating world. It is a dreamlike underwater landscape represented by her collection *The Eternal Nautilus* for Spring/Summer 2026; the irresistible melody of the sirens' song, joined by the hypnotic rhythm of the waves, forms the backdrop to a fashion that awakens the senses and freedom. A song that materializes in clothes that seem to vibrate thanks to impalpable layers of fabric and flowing volumes, like ocean waves.

In Sirivannavari's seasonal pieces, the Nautilus is not just a decorative element but gives shape to enveloping drapes, while the world of the abyss emerges and mixes with urban beachwear featuring more functional cuts. Harem pants, sailor dresses, modern silhouettes with mini skirts, sporty jackets, long cover-ups, and all the accessories that complete the story bring the echo of the waves into the city. The

palette mixes white with tones of blue, azure, and coral, combined with precious embroideries created by Sirivannavari Atelier and Academy using applications of shells, lace, and hand-painted fabrics. «The *Iris* jacket in silk taffeta is the symbolic piece of the season», says the creative director. An emblem of how craftsmanship and the care of garments are the key to celebrating Thai savoir-faire, honoring cultural heritage, and promoting the textile future of the Southeast Asian country.